

Sushant Bhardwaj

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Professional Summary

Cybersecurity student with hands-on experience in SOC operations, network security monitoring, vulnerability assessment, risk management, and security compliance documentation. Skilled in IBM QRadar, Splunk, firewalls, encryption, Windows/Linux, log analysis, and incident reporting. Independent security researcher featured in **Dark Reading** for responsibly disclosing critical vulnerabilities in national government IT systems.

Press Feature

Dark Reading – “*Vulnerabilities Expose Private Data in Indian Government Systems*” June 2026

- Featured as independent researcher for disclosing 14 vulnerabilities (2 critical, 4 high) in national civil service and education portals; quoted on root causes (configuration weaknesses, IAM gaps, access-control issues). All findings remediated within 2–3 weeks.

Education

B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering (Cyber Security) – SRM Institute of Science and Technology (SRMIST), Delhi NCR 2024 – 2028

Certifications

Microsoft AZ-900 | Cisco CCST Cybersecurity | Fortinet FCF & FCA | Certified Blue Team Practitioner (CBTP) | Oracle OCI AI Foundations Associate

Experience

Cyber Security Intern – Axis Max Life Insurance Ltd. (SOC Operations) May 2026 – Present

- Supported network security monitoring, alert triage, event analysis, and incident investigation in a live SOC.
- Assisted threat detection, incident response workflows, and escalation of suspicious activities.
- Performed vulnerability assessments and security risk identification across business applications.
- Created incident reports, investigation notes, and security/compliance documentation.

Cyber Security Intern – DRDO – Solid State Physics Laboratory (SSPL) Dec 2025

- Worked on web application security, VAPT fundamentals, and security assessment methodologies under government protocols.
- Assisted cybersecurity reporting and technical documentation supporting risk management and compliance.

Independent Security Researcher & Bug Bounty Practitioner – HackerOne Sep 2025 – Present

- Reported IDOR, access-control, and misconfiguration vulnerabilities via responsible disclosure (CERT-In, govt. portals).
- Conducted recon, enumeration, and web app security testing using Burp Suite; findings featured in Dark Reading.

Projects

SSH Honeypot Deployment & SOC Investigation

- Deployed Cowrie SSH Honeypot; analyzed brute-force attacks via log analysis and simulated SOC workflows (threat detection, event correlation, reporting).

Custom TCP Port Scanner with Banner Grabbing

- Developed a Python-based TCP scanner supporting service enumeration and banner grabbing.

Achievements

- Findings featured in **Dark Reading**, a leading international cybersecurity publication (June 2026).
- **CERT-In Hall of Fame** recipient for responsible disclosure of security vulnerabilities.
- Submitted 6+ validated vulnerability reports involving access-control and sensitive-data exposure findings.
- Ranked #14 among 266 participants in the HAXCAMP Splunk SIEM Challenge (290/300).

Technical Skills

Security & Compliance: Vulnerability Assessment & Management, Risk Management, Threat Hunting, OWASP Top 10, DFIR Fundamentals

SIEM & SOC: IBM QRadar, Splunk, Alert Triage, Event Correlation, Log Analysis, Incident Response

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, Firewalls, Encryption **OS:** Windows, Linux, Kali Linux

Tools: Burp Suite, Wireshark, Nmap **Programming:** Python, SQL, Bash, C++